

RETURN TO HOMEGROWN LEADERSHIP



N.R. Narayan Murthy
Founder & CEO
1981-2002



Nandan Nilekani
Internal
2002-2007



Kris Gopalakrishnan
Internal
2007-2011



S.D. Shibulal
Internal
2011-2014



Vishal Sikka
External
2014-2017



U.B. Pravin Rao
Internal (interim)
2017



Salil Parekh
External
2018-2027



Ashiss Kumar Dash
Internal (to take charge)
April 2027 onwards

THE NEW INVESTORS

► The leadership transition comes as Infosys remains financially resilient, reporting ₹48,211 crore in Q1FY27 revenue, ₹7,769 crore in net profit. The FY26 revenue was ₹1.79 lakh crore in FY26

► Infosys' decision to appoint 31-year veteran Ashiss Kumar Dash is a signal the board believes that the AI era demands leaders who can transform the organisation without disrupting its foundations

► While generative AI is reshaping IT services, the company still needs a CEO who can manage large-scale delivery, global clients and a workforce of over 300,000 along with technological change

► Dash will have to accelerate AI adoption while continuing to run the traditional IT services business that still generates the bulk of revenues—proving that agility and scale can coexist

ogy companies, global IT services firms are extraordinarily complex organisations. They simultaneously manage hundreds of large client relationships, thousands of ongoing transformation programmes, delivery centres across continents and workforces that rival the population of small cities. Running such a business demands far more than technological vision. It requires institutional memory.

According to Anandurup Ghose, Partner and CHRO Programme Leader at Deloitte India, the appointment also reflects a characteristic often overlooked in Indian IT. "Some Indian companies have traditionally maintained a long bench of leaders waiting for the CEO role. Like several Indian IT services companies, it has consistently developed leaders internally because these organisations are built around deep knowledge of clients, delivery models and the company's way of operating."

That institutional continuity is

particularly valuable during periods of technological transition.

At first glance, the AI era appears to favour leaders with cutting-edge product backgrounds or experience building frontier AI companies. But enterprise technology rarely changes as dramatically as headlines suggest.

While generative AI is rapidly altering software development and consulting, a substantial portion of global IT spending continues to be directed towards maintaining enterprise systems, integrating applications and running mission-critical infrastructure. The incoming CEO therefore inherits two businesses at once where one has to evolve rapidly, and the other isn't allowed to fail.

Ghose argues that this balancing act explains why operational experience remains indispensable.

"You need someone who appreciates AI, but also someone capable of managing an organisation of this scale. A significant part of

Indian IT services is still traditional implementation, integration and application management. The challenge is transforming the business without disrupting the engine that already exists."

According to experts, for an IT company, the competitive advantage lies in helping large enterprises deploy AI securely, responsibly and at scale. That shifts the definition of innovation.

The next CEO must convince global clients that Infosys can modernise decades-old technology estates while simultaneously introducing AI into business processes without disrupting operations.

Infosys' choice suggests the board believes the AI race will not simply be won by the boldest vision or the loudest narrative but by leaders capable of modernising a global enterprise without losing the trust of its clients, employees and investors. **BT**

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